MODULE-I

INTRODUCTION

Objectives:-

1. To introduce the very definition of ethics

2. To introduce nature and scope of ethics

3. To explain Good -Bad- right- Wrong

INTRODUCTION

The word philosophy is a combination of two Greek nouns, philia which means “love” or “friendship,” and sophia which means “wisdom.” We may therefore translate the word philosophy as “the love of wisdom.” A philosopher, consequently, is “a lover of wisdom.”

Philosophy is a branch of human inquiry and as such it aims at knowledge and understanding. We might expect that the value of philosophy lies in the value of the ends that it seeks, the knowledge and understanding it reveals. Plato states that philosophy aims at the knowledge of the eternal,of the essential nature of things. The ancient Greek thinker Pythagoras first use the term ‘philosopher’ with reference to the wise who were devoted to the study of the fundamental nature of reality. Plato had popularized the term ‘philosophy’ as distinguishable from the mythology and Paganism of ancient people. Socrates had introduced dialectical analysis as the characteristic method of philosophy

Wisdom indeed involves knowledge, but it also includes the ability, the inclination, and the steady purpose of putting knowledge to good use. According to St. Thomas Aquinas that a man is to be called wise when he knows what he has to do and plans and manages to do it well. Thus wisdom involves several things: an end or purpose to be attained ; an appreciative knowledge of this purpose ; an ability, an inclination, and a steadfast effort to achieve the known purpose in the best possible manner. Thus it is wisdom to work for a known good purpose in a steady, devoted, and enlightened way. The core branches of philosophy include metaphysics,epistemology,logic,aesthetics and ethics. Metaphysics studies the fundamental nature of reality and existence,epistemology is the study of knowledge and its limits,logic is

the study of reasoning and argumentation,aesthetics is a branch of philosophy that examines the nature of beauty,art, and the value of aesthetic experiences. Ethics is the branch of philosophy concerned with questions of morality, including what constitutes good or bad actions, and the basis for ethical judgments.

The teaching of Socrates made moral philosophy at the forefront of philosophical thought, if we look into the history of ethics in Greek thought it could be seen it was from Socrates that all subsequent ethical thoughts diverge. Socrates, Plato and Aristotle hold a unique place in the history of moral philosophy. Plato himself regards his work being influenced by the Socratic dialectical method. Aristotle's work can be regarded as restatement of the continually renewed research of Plato's work.

The Cynic and the Cyrenaic schools have their due credits as subordinate; the opposition between virtue and pleasure being one of them, in the post Aristotelian period this was taken up by Stoics and Epicureans.

Aristotle considers the pure activity of universal abstract thought is the final cause and the first source of the whole process of change in the concrete world. Plato also holds that it is the speculative intellect which is the highest mode of human existence. The philosopher should be concerned with the affairs of ordinary human life, only by realizing the perfect moral excellence that highest good will be attained.

The striking feature of Plato's dialogues is the Socratic induction also deductive method is used in ethics. His vision is using common sense as supplying provisional steps so a to ascend to the knowledge of the absolute good. Plato considers speculative wisdom as not able to determine moral questions. The exercises which it involves is highest forms of human activity, though unable to define what good is. Practical wisdom serves its purpose in determining moral excellence as constituted by due limitation of feeling and action in which perfect virtue consists. It is not the selection of means to certain ends that virtue consists in instead his ends should be rightly chosen.

In the post Aristotelian period around 300 BC to 300 AD the prominent schools being that of Plato, Aristotle, Zeno and Epicurus and their mutual relations evaluated. Until the close of the 2nd century it was stoicism which took the lead. Peripatetic or Aristotelian school may be considered as moderate orthodoxy since it overlooks minor changes.

Cicero's writing depicts the influence of stoics in Roman's thought process, even the writing of Seneca and Marcus Aurelius shows the how stoics influenced later roman thought.

There are transitions in historical outlook of the platonic thought, the first phase being philosophical skepticism where ethical teaching is dubious. Moderate orthodoxy of the Peripatetics takes over the skepticism which culminates in mysticism of Neo-Platonism of

Plotinus in the 3rd century . Plotinus ethics is a self-directed, metaphysics-based system focused on elevating the soul from the material world to union with the One (the ultimate Good). It centers on "becoming like God" through purification, cultivating cardinal virtues, and intellectual contemplation, turning the soul away from bodily passions toward the divine intellect. According to Aristotle, moral virtue is the only practical road to effective action. The virtuous person sees truly and judges rightly, since beautiful things appear as they truly are only to a person of good character.

1.1 DEFINITION -

Ethics is the science of conduct. It considers the actions of human beings with reference to their rightness or wrongness. The word "ethics" is derived from the Greek word *ethos*, which means "character" and from the Latin word *mores*, which means customs. Mackenzie defines ethics as “the study of what is right or good in human conduct” or “the science of the ideal involved in conduct”. So, it is clear that ethics is the study which determines rightness or wrongness of actions. Ethics then, we may say, discusses men’s habits or customs, or in other words their characters, the principles on which the habitually act and considers what it is that constitutes the rightness or wrongness of these principles, the good or evil of these habits. These terms however, “Right” and “Good”, seems to require a little explanation.

a. Right:- The term Right is derived from the Latin rectus, meaning ‘straight’ or ‘according to rule’. When we a say, then, that conduct is right, we mean primarily that it is according to rule.

b. Good:- The term Good is connected with the German *“gut”*. A thing is generally said to be good when it is valuable for some end. Thus, a particular kind of medicine are said to be good for this or that complaint. Similarly, when we speak of conduct as good, we may mean that it is serviceable for the end we have in view.

Thus, we can say that the science of ethics is concerned with the rightness or goodness of human conduct.

1.2 ETHICAL CONCEPTS OF GOOD AND BAD

Ethical concepts such as good and bad are central to understanding human behaviour and moral judgement. From early childhood individuals learn to distinguish actions that are considered good and those which are considered bad. These concepts help guide personal conduct, social relationship and decision making in everyday life.

The concept good generally refers to actions, intention or character traits that promote wellbeing, harmony and happiness. Good actions are often associated with values such as honesty,kindness,compassion and fairness. When a person helps someone in need, tells the truth, or acts selflessly ,such behaviour is commonly regarded as morally good because it benefits others and strengthens trust within society.

In contrast bad refers to actions or behaviour that cause harm, injustice or suffering. Lying, stealing,cruelty and exploitation are typically considered bad because they violate moral standards and damage relationships, bad actions often arise from negative traits such as greed, hatred or selfishness and they disrupt social order and moral balance.

The distinction between good and bad is not always simple or absolute. Ethical dilemmas arise when an action produces both positive and negative outcomes. For example, telling a painful truth may cause a temporary harm but lead to long term good. In such situations ethical reasoning help individuals to evaluate intentions, consequences and moral duties before deciding what is right or wrong. Cultural, religious and philosophical traditions also influence how good and bad are understood. While moral values may differ across societies, many ethical systems share common ideas such as the belief that harming innocent people is wrong and helping others is good. This shard moral understanding allows people from different background so cooperate and live together peacefully.

The ethical concepts of good and bad play a vital role in shaping human behaviour and moral awareness. They help individuals evaluate their actions, take responsibility of their choices, and strive to live a way that promotes justice and well-being. Understanding these concepts is essential for personal growth and building morally responsible society.

A good person is one who thinks about the needs of others and acts responsibly, even when no reward is expected. Bad refers to actions that cause harm, suffering or injustice. Bad actions

often arise from negative emotions. However, the difference between good and bad actions is not always clear cut. In a certain situation a person may face a moral dilemma where an action has both good and bad consequences. For example, telling the truth may cause pain but prevent greater harm in the future. In such a case the individual must consider their intentions and outcome of their actions before making a decision. Most societies agree on the basic principles such as valuing honesty, discouraging violence and encouraging compassion. These shared values help maintain order and cooperation in human society.

By choosing good over bad individuals contribute to their own moral development and to the creation of a just and caring society.

Meaning of the word good is "*fitting", "suitable"* or "*worthy"*. Over time the word developed strong moral and ethical connotations referring not only to usefulness or quality but also to moral rightness. In early usage good was applied boldly to people,actions,objects and conditions. Its moral sense emerged as societies began associating goodness with virtues like kindness, honesty and righteousness. Thus, the ethical meaning of good evolved from the idea of something being suitable or beneficial to something being morally right.

The term bad has been used in English forever. Unlike good its original roots are unclear. Originally bad meant poor in quality or defective. Overtime it developed a strong moral sense coming to represent evil, wrong or harmful actions. The evolution of the words good and bad shows how language reflects moral development.

Today they serve as fundamental concepts of moral philosophy, helping individuals evaluate actions, intentions, and character. Plato viewed good as the highest reality and the ultimate source of truth and knowledge. According to him form of the good is the supreme principle that gives meaning to all other values. Actions are good when they align with reason and justice. While bad actions result from ignorance and lack of true knowledge. For Plato a just soul and a just society reflect the triumph of the good over bad.

Aristotle understood good in terms of purpose and human flourishing. He argued that highest good is Eudaimonia. That means happiness or wellbeing achieved through practise of virtue. Good actions are those which follow the golden mean avoiding extremes of excess and deficiency. Bad actions arise when individuals act without moderation or fail to cultivate virtuous character traits. Confucious emphasized moral goodness through social harmony and proper conduct. According to Kant good act is one performed out of respect for moral law not personal desire or consequences.

1.3 ETHICAL CONCEPT OF RIGHT AND WRONG

The concepts of right and wrong as of the concept of good and bad are central to ethical thinking. They help human beings to judge actions, intentions and decisions. Guiding behaviour in personal, social and professional contexts. Every society develops moral standards that define what is considered right and wrong enabling individuals to live together in harmony.

Right refers to actions that are morally acceptable and ethically justified, telling the truth, helping those in need. Such actions are guided by honesty fairness, responsibility and respect for others. Doing what is right often involves acting according to moral rules, social norms or ethical principles even when it is difficult or involves personal sacrifice. For example, telling the truth, helping those in need, respecting the rights of others are generally regarded as right actions.

Wrong refers to actions that violate moral principle or cause harm to others. Acts such as lying,cheating,stealing or causing injustice are considered wrong because they undermine trust fairness and social order. Wrong actions often arise from selfish motives, ignorance or disregard for moral responsibility, and they can lead to guilt, punishment or social disapproval. The distinction between right and wrong is not always simple. Moral dilemmas arise when a person needs to choose between two conflicting values where every option may involve some harm. In such situations ethical reasoning becomes important. Individuals must consider intention consequences and moral duty before deciding what is right. Philosophers have proposed different approaches to resolve such dilemmas including duty-based ethics, consequence-based ethics and virtue ethics. Cultural religious and social factors also influence ideas of right and wrong. Though moral standards vary across societies, shared values such as respect for life, justice and compassion that are widely recognised. These common moral principles help maintain peace in human communities.

The concepts of right and wrong play a vital role in shaping moral behaviour and ethical judgement. They guide individuals in making responsible choices and help societies establish order and justice. Understanding and practicing what is right while avoiding what is wrong is essential for personal integrity and the wellbeing of society.

1.3.1 Etymology of right and wrong

The word Right comes from the old English word "*riht"* or "*ryht"* which means straight ,correct or just. It is derived from the Proto-Germanic root "*rehtaz"* which means straight or direct, this is also related to latin word *rectus* which means straight or upright.

Originally right described physical straightness or correctness. Overtime, its meaning expanded to include legal, moral and ethical correctness. In ethics rights came to signify actions that are morally proper, just and in accordance with law or moral standards.

The word wrong comes from the old English word "*wrang"* which means crooked twisted or unjust. It is derived from the Proto-Germanic root "*wranguz"*,which conveyed the idea of something bent, distorted or out of order. Originally wrong referred to something physically twisted or incorrect. Gradually it occurred a moral sense coming to represent injustice, error or immoral behaviour. In ethics wrong came to signify actions that deviate from moral or legal standards. The etymological contrast between right and wrong reflects a deep symbolic understanding of morality. What is right is seen as straight, proper and orderly, while what is is wrong is viewed as distorted and unjust. This linguistic development shows how moral concepts evolved from physical descriptions to ethical judgements.

The idea of right and wrong are central to moral philosophy. Moral philosophers across different ages and cultures have tried to explain how human actions should be judged and what makes an action morally right or wrong. Their views differ depending on whether they emphasize reason, consequences, duty, virtue or social harmony. Plato believed that right and wrong are objective and rooted in reason. For him an action is right when it aligns with justice and rational order wrong when it arises from ignorance uncontrolled desires. According to Plato moral knowledge leads to right action and wrongdoing is a result of lack of true knowledge. Aristotle viewed right and wrong in terms of virtue and moderation. He states that an action is right if it follows the golden mean, a balanced path between excess and deficiency. Wrong actions occur when a person acts excessively or deficiently falling to cultivate virtuous character. Right action to Aristotle leads to eudaimonia that means human flourishing.

Is there norms under which rightness or wrongness of action depends, if aesthetics is a normative science under which a object is classified as beautiful or ugly there are some criteria which makes us to classify it as it is. Normative science defines an ideal but it does not lay down the rules for its attainment. We can provide an ideal through which a conduct may said to be good or bad but it does not provide the way by which we can realize the ideal. This is the reason by which ethics is called a speculative science rather than a practical science. The intention of the moral life is not directed toward attaining one result; hence it means a definite

set of rules cannot serve the purpose to which it is directed. If someone says that 90 percent of all adults of certain part of world are overweight, this norm, is not derived from the result of a statistical survey, i.e., it is not a comparison of weight of each individual with the average weight of the group of the population. Instead, they have a ideal weight for the people relative to their height are other factors, and this is used as a norm or standard in the sense of ideal model. It means it is not the statistically normalcy that we refer to instead the weight of the majority of individuals is more than they ought to be.

Most writers of ethics have taken ethics to be speculative. Ethics is not considered a practical science, it deals with understanding the nature of ideal, it does not formulate rules for its attainment

1.4 NATURE AND SCOPE OF ETHICS

Mathematics teaches us to how to calculate and measure. Similarly subjects like physics, biology, and economics is related directly to certain well recognised fields of human action. There are also pure science which is knowledge for its own sake, it is well known that it is in pursuit of this knowledge that practical applications of science have been discovered. So we can understand that it is the practical in knowledge that attracts our interest. And ethics is no exception to this rule.

The answer to the question why do we study ethics, is that it tells us how to act rightly; what actions are right or wrong, good or bad. So, ethics is defined as the science which deals with conduct in so far as this is considered right or wrong, good or bad.

So is there is a "science" or field of human knowledge, that can tell us what actions are right or wrong, what are good or bad, it must take an important place in our scheme of human knowledge and in any system of education.

The most important thing to know in this world and in this life is what is good and what is bad. There are right and wrong way of doing things. For example, there is right and wrong way of building a bridge, there is right and wrong way of performing a surgical operation, right and wrong ways of doing business, of carrying on economic operations.

In the above cases what is good and bad in these cases is relatively simple. A good bridge is one that is safe for travel. A good operation is one that is safe for travel. A good operation is one that saves a human life or restores an organ to its normal functioning. Good business practice is that which shows profit. So, the engineer,surgeon,and merchant should learn these ways. These things have to do with the means or instruments of life, but it is important to know what are the right ends. It is possible for a man to know all about the means to accomplish ends but have very little sense for the ends of life themselves. One can see that a

person can be skilled in a technical field, but be very stupid about values of life. It means that that there are right and wrong ways of doing things in the larger relations of life, it is with these that ethics is concerned.

Nobody will deny the importance of knowing what is good and what is bad in human behaviour or action. If there is a science that can tell us this, then it is clearly a very important field of study. There are also people who deny the importance of ethics because they think that people already know without any special knowledge, what is good or bad, right or wrong. From the view point of a healthy human understanding we know what we ought to do. **It is not lack of knowledge but lack of goodwill.**

In the modern scenario men are often confused about what is right and wrong. Even knowledge of the science of morals is questioned. Some states that "there's nothing good or bad but thinking makes it so", meaning thereby that moral distinctions are matters of personal feeling or of group and lack entirely that objectivity that belongs to knowledge. This subjectivism if justified, make impossible any science of ethics. Rather than calling science we can say that there is little doubt that there is moral knowledge of some sort, that truth may be discovered in the field of morals and that it may be organised and imparted to others.

It is out of use or value as a study that definition of ethics arises. Ethics is the science that deals with conduct in so far as it is considered right or wrong. It is by experience that we know what things are hot or cold. In order to know what is true or false we can know only by certain methods of verification or testing. In this sense meaning of the terms is given immediately. Same is the case for the terms like good and bad, right and wrong. But we can make the terms clear by definition, it makes meanings more definite. Terms like hot and cold have to do with the qualities while true and false with the reasons or causes, of things; good and bad with the values of things. Ethics then is the study which deals with the value of things.

Wonder or curiosity is the beginning of all investigation and ends in what we call knowledge or science. For example, Isaac Newton asked the question why apple falls to the ground and discovered as his answer the law of gravitation. Similarly answer for the question why light from two different objects at different distances led to the formulation of the theory of relativity by Einstein, which involved not only the reinterpretation of gravitation, but a reconstruction of our notions of space and time themselves. So the development of science leads to a body of answers to certain general questions of this sort.

A child may ask question of what is good of doing certain things, like going to school, going to church he may find the reason for doing the particular act and value of the particular act becomes part of a larger scheme of life and life's value. One may recognise the aesthetic value in poetry to other values of life such as practical an scientific.

Our mind can still travel further than this in its thought about values of things and actions. Child can even ask the question what is the good of being good. This question points to the involvement of ultimate problem of ethics.

So the question remains that why there should be any distinction between good and bad at all. The answer to this question would take one to the heart of ethical theory. So the child wonders whether there is any ultimate meaning or value to life at all and the world in which he finds himself. So he is led from ethics in to still more ultimate questions which we call philosophical or metaphysical.

Ethics is primarily a part of the quest for truth and the motives for studying it are desirable for knowledge. It enquires into the nature of the springs of actions, motives, intentions, voluntary actions and so on. It determines rightness or wrongness of human actions. It does not enquire into the origin and growth of human conduct. As a science of morality ethics discusses the contents of moral consciousness and the various problems of moral consciousness.

Ethics is concerned with the highest good or absolute good. It investigates the nature of its fundamental notions i.e. right, duty and good. Moral judgments passed on our voluntary actions are also included within the scope of ethics. In discussing the moral judgment, it has also to concern with the nature, object, faculty and standard of moral judgment. Moral sentiments and feelings are arising in our mind when we contemplate about the moral judgment and therefore, ethics has to discuss the nature of moral sentiments to moral judgment.

The scope of ethics includes whatever has reference to free human acts, whether as principle or cause of action, or as effect or circumstance of action. Ethics discusses the nature of human freedom. Ethics investigates what constitutes good or bad, just or unjust. It also inquiries into-what are virtue, law, conscience and duty? What obligations are common to all? What is the good in all good acts? These questions lie within the scope of ethics. The sense of duty, or moral obligation and the responsibility for actions are also included within the range of ethics.

The particular aspect under which ethics considers free acts is that of their moral goodness or the rectitude of order involved in them as human acts. A man may be a good artist or orator and at the same time a morally bad man or, conversely, a morally good man may be a poor artist or technician. Ethics has merely to do with the order which relates to man as man and which makes of him a good man. Thus, we find that although Ethics is not a guidebook of

moral rules as a branch of philosophy Ethics seeks clarification of terms used in moral language. The 'meta-ethical" problems fall within the scope of philosophical aspect of ethics. There is other 'meta ethical discussions related to the nature of moral judgments, the logical basis of ethical evaluation etc.

The applied dimension of ethics is known as "Applied Ethics' that falls within the broad field of ethics. These comprise the areas of situational Ethics while Meta Ethics deals with logical and semantic questions like 'What do we mean by "freedom" and "determinism" etc. Ethics is essentially related to all other branches of knowledge like sociology, political science, jurisprudence, law and legal study, psychology, anthropology, culture study, ecology and environmental study, economics, religion, aesthetics and other similar areas. Ethics is concerned with political, sociological, cultural, psychical, economic, environmental, religious problems in pursuit of highest good. So, these problems have an additional place in the scope of ethics. With the emergence of new technology there is scope for widening the scope of ethics to address new issues.

1.4.1 **Ethics in decision making**

Ethics includes the rules and guidelines that specifically govern the behaviour of individuals and groups within society. Ethics influences how people think,act in personal, professional or social situations. Ethics plays a crucial role in helping us take decisions in day to day situations, particularly in the complex nature of problems in today's scenario. Usually, our day to day behaviour affect others, the more we adhere to ethical principles the more we contribute towards an equal, fair and peaceful society.

It is the ethical principles which guide actions which we may or may not be consciously thinking about and form a way in which we determine what other people do or not. Ethics helps us distinguish between right and wrong actions and also makes us understand the implications of our actions on others. The other virtue involved along with law and regulation are honesty,integrity,equity,and self respect.

The different perspectives involved are :

1. **Personal Ethics** -

Personal ethics refers to the values and moral principles guiding a person's behaviour. The upbringing,culture, religion, and other individual exposures influence personal ethics. Personal ethics in way guides people to make value based decisions. Ethical behaviour is crucial since it gives a sense of trust in relations. We come to experience personal fulfillment

and respect for oneself through our ethical conduct. Ethical decisions helps us decide on what is beneficial to us and possibly evade what will possibly harm others or us.

2. **Professional Ethics -**

Professional ethics provide a guideline on the way they should conduct themselves in a manner that is thoughtful, just and honest in their professional lives and communication. Honesty and integrity is an important part of professional life, which allows us for a setting in which trust and respect is built.

There is a need to treat all people with relative fairness regardless of race,color,creed,and gender. Certain professions such as medicine, law and finance are expected to respect the privacy of the clients,patient,or customer. It is also mandatory that decisions must always be made in the best interest of all parties. Companies should ensure that the entities make profits but positive ones for the society by environmental sustainability or by giving donations for charity.

3. **Social ethics -**

Social ethics will guide our conduct in society in terms of our relationship with family and friends and also our general roles within it. Societies are modeled on the basis of the values that enforce the rules between individuals, based on how laws are developed and applied, and based on how social mechanism works. Ethics in a way promotes amicable social relationship by instilling respectfulness and cooperation among its members. The ethical principles that are made to take care of human rights,equity,and avoid exploitation guides the way of laws.

Having a policy of ethics in a society are less likely to make space for dishonestness and corruption is through the aspect of societal ethical behaviour that ensures basic human rights and freedom. So by having ethical conduct in business, politics and international relations, it will help enhance peace and cooperation across borders.

1.4.2 Ethical concepts and their significance in daily life

Ethics plays a fundamental role in shaping human behaviour relationships and societies. Derived from the greek word *"ethos"* meaning character or custom ethics refers to the moral principles that guide individuals in distinguishing between right and wrong. Ethical concepts are not abstract ideas limited to philosophy books they are deeply woven in to everyday decisions from how we treat others to how we fulfil our responsibilities at work and society. In a world increasingly shaped by technology, globalisation and cultural diversity, ethical awareness has become more important than ever.

a) Moral values and integrity

Moral value such as honesty,respect,kindness and fairness from the foundation of ethical behaviour. Integrity, the consistency between ones values and actions is a key ethical concept that influence trust and credibility. In daily life, integrity is reflected when individuals speak the truth even when lying would be easier or when they uphold principles despite external pressure.

Integrity fosters trust in personal relationship and professional environment and making it essential for healthy social interactions and long term success.

b) Responsibility and accountability

Responsibility refers to the obligation to act rightly, accountability involves accepting the consequences of one's action. These concepts are central to ethical living since they promote self-discipline and reliability.

c) Justice and fairness

Justice is the ethical concept concerned with fairness and impartiality. It requires treating people according to moral or legal standards rather than personal bias. Fairness plays a vital role in maintaining social balance and preventing exploitation.

d) Respect and Human dignity

Respect is a core ethical concept which acknowledges the inherent worth of every individuals. It involves recognising differences in beliefs, cultures and opinions and lifestyles without discrimination or hostility. In daily life respect is shown through polite communication, listening to others, valuing personal boundaries and refraining from harmful behaviour. Respect for human dignity is significant in multicultural societies where peaceful coexistence depends on tolerance and mutual understanding.

e) Empathy and compassion

Empathy is the ability to understand and share the feelings of others. Compassion involves taking action alleviate their suffering. These ethical concepts encourage kindness and moral sensitivity in everyday life.

f) Honesty and truthfulness

Honesty is one of the most valued ethical principles. It involves truthfulness in speech actions and intentions. Honesty in daily life builds trust in relationship.

g) Ethical decision making and moral reasoning

Ethical reasoning helps individuals make balanced decisions. Ethical decision making involves evaluating choices based on moral principles rather than convenience or self-interest alone. Moral reasoning allows individuals to consider consequences, intentions and values before acting. Daily life often presents ethical dilemma such as choosing between personal benefit and fairness, loyalty and truth or comfort and responsibility. Developing ethical reasoning helps individuals make balanced decisions that consider both personal and social impacts.

h) Professional ethics and work ethics

Professional ethics govern behaviour in workplace and specific professions. Such as medicine,law,education and business. Work ethics emphasize dedication,punctuality,honesty and respect for colleagues. In daily professional life, ethical conduct prevents corruption, exploitation and misconduct. Ethical workplaces foster trust productivity and long term sustainability.

j) Environmental ethics

Environmental ethics focusses on moral responsibility toward nature and future generations as environmental changes such as climate change and pollution intensity intensify ethical awareness about sustainability has become crucial. In daily life environmental ethics are practised by reducing waste, conserving energy, using resources responsibly, and supporting eco-friendly practices. Ethical concern for environment reflects respect for life beyond human interest and emphasize long-term thinking over short term gain.

k) Digital ethics in modern life

With the rise of technology, digital ethics have become increasingly relevant issue. Issues such as privacy,data security,cyber bullying, misinformation and responsible use of technology pose new ethical challenges. In daily lives digital ethics involve respecting others privacy, sharing accurate information, avoiding online harassment and using technology responsibly.

Hence, we come to understand that ethical concepts are not abstract ideals but practical guidelines which guides humanity toward more just and compassionate future.

1.5 COMPARING WESTERN AND INDIAN ETHICS

Western ethics is generally characterized by individualism, rationalism, and adherence to universal moral rules, often focusing on rights and justice. Western ethics spans multifaceted paradigms. Aristotelian virtue ethics foregrounds character edification and phronesis for eudaimonia, viewing moral growth as habituated rational praxis. Kantian deontology pivots on duty derived from rational autonomy, positing that moral acts adhere to the categorical imperative, affirming personal dignity and principled uniformity (Bilimoria, 2021). Benthamite and Millian utilitarianism appraises deeds by their utility in augmenting aggregate happiness, prioritizing the greatest good for the greatest number through consequentialist calculus.

Conversely, Indian ethics is deeply rooted in spirituality, duty (dharma), and interconnectedness, emphasizing internal transformation, character, and cosmic order (karma). If we look in to the ethical foundation of the philosophical schools of India, first of all traditional Indian thinking is spiritualistic with a firm belief that man has soul within him as the real being. So this spiritual aspect of human person is the highest goal which his natural inclinations lead to. He needs a vision which make him achieve his ideal, which helps him to go towards higher spiritual plane. So there is a need to adopt a moral point of view.

In the Vedas, particularly in Rig Veda, the concept of *Rta*, the concept of Dharma and the concept of karma become the central moral principles. It can be seen that the upanishads stresses the importance of moksha as the highest goal reached by good conduct and pursuit of knowledge. For the Vedic and vedantic traditions the Dharmasastras were considered as the moral codes. In the Manusmriti there were strict injunctions and practical guidelines for human conduct with respective rights and duties although from caste categories. It can be seen that the Dharmasastras, Epics and the Puranas share common *ethos* but each of them having a specific goal. The epics teach ethical ideals and thoughts of Hindu system. There is emphasis for Karma yoga and jnana yoga in the Bhagavad Gita for the attainment of supreme bliss. It is based upon the metaphysical and epistemological positions that the philosophical schools of Vedic and Vedantic tradition focusses on their ethical concepts and conduct.

1. In indian thought there are four values which give meaning to human life, they are called *purusharthas*

1)Dharma 2)Artha 3)Kama 4)Moksha

Dharma -

Through the ages the term Dharma acquired more and more meaning hence the term became complex and varied meanings. The dictionary suggests words like virtue,righteousness,duty,morality,justice etc.

According to Sankara, Dharma is observance of truth in conduct of life. Hence, Dharma is the way of life embodying the truth perceived. Dharma is usually distinguished into sadharana dharma and varnashrama dharma. Sadharana dharma refers to the duties of the universal scope and validity. The varnasrama dharma refers to the duties of persons according to the social classes and the stages of life.

Artha -

Means "goal," "purpose," or "essence" in Sanskrit, extending beyond money to include all means required for a meaningful life. Generally, it means attainment of riches and worldly prosperity, profit and wealth. According to Kautilya it means both economic and political aspects of man's life in the society. Economic wellbeing is essential since absence of which could lead one to do immoral deeds to satisfy himself.

Kama -

It is a foundational concept in Indian philosophy representing desire, pleasure, emotional fulfilment, and aesthetic enjoyment**.** In the Indian context there is always a clear emphasis on the enjoyment of secular pleasures along with the emphasis on the realisation of spiritual values.

Moksha -

Moksha is also known by other names like *mukti, kaivalya* and *nirvana*. Of the *Purusharthas* this is the *Paramapurushartha*, the first three *Dharma,Artha* and *Kama* are treated as the instrumental values by most schools of indian philosophy.

In its positive aspect it means supreme bliss and liberation,while in the negative sense it signifies complete freedom from sorrow. Most of the Indian school of thought accepted the theory of karma and rebirth and the ideal of moksha is conceived as the liberation from the cycle of births and deaths.

2. Ethics in Buddhism -

The core of the Buddhist belief is contained in the four noble truths

a) Life is full of suffering;

b) The cause of suffering is desire or craving;

c) Eliminating suffering is liberation;

and the final is the means for attaining Nirvana is eightfold path.

The foundation of the Buddhist ethics is on the unchanging laws of nature and not on the changing social customs. Buddhist ethical virtues are part of nature and the unchanging law of cause and effect. In Buddhism morality is only a means leading to the final goal of ultimate happiness. The Buddhist advise is on conditions which were most wholesome and conducive to long term benefit for self and others. It is through various precepts that Buddhist ethics finds its practical expression. These precepts are general guides to show the direction in which the Buddhist ought to turn on its way to find salvation.

3. Ethics in Jainism -

In order to attain moksha Jainism prescribes a threefold path known as *Triratna* (Three jewels). They are right faith, right knowledge and right conduct. Primary importance is given to right conduct without which it is useless the observe the former two.

According to Jainism all the objects and modifications of the universe come under the two principles, soul and non-soul. Feeling, perception, consciousness are found in the impure soul. Body is included in the non-soul. It is through the good and bad activities of mind, body and speech are the causes for the inflow of karmic matter; these are causes for bondage. It is by removing this bondage that liberation happens.

4. Hedonism in ethics of *Carvaka*

Carvaka criticizes the Vedic ritualism and ceremonialism. Regarding the ethical teaching it can be equated with epicureanism and Hedonism. *Carvakas* says that attaining and enjoying maximum pleasure in this life is the only goal of man, because there is no other world or life beyond the present one. Carvaka system is purely materialistic, hedonistic and anti-vedic doctrine.

1.6 IS AND OUGHT

It should be noted that, although many philosophers speak as if the is-ought problem were a problem in logic, the question does not belong to the domain of the science of logic at all. The problem can, of course, be expressed in logical terms, for the impossibility of deriving an "ought" from an "is" can be rendered as the inability to reach prescriptive premises from descriptive conclusions. Despite the use of the terminology of logic in setting up the problem, however, there exists no necessity from the point of view of the science of logic alone why one should expect to be able to derive an "ought" from an "is." No paradox or antinomy results from this inability, and prescriptive conclusions can be produced by the expedient of utilizing a prescriptive premise.

There is difference between the statements the " The bridge is 2km long" and the "bridge the is beautiful" also the statement "the design in the cloth is fabric painting" and " the design in the cloth looks good". In the above cases the former is cognitive statement latter is aesthetic statement. Usually, it it poses difficulties when ethical words like "good", "ought"," right","wrong','ought"," duty" are used and how the assertions are interpreted. An act that contributes to happiness is considered as right.

In the non-cognitivist view of moral judgement, moral statement do not express any state of belief or state of facts, rather they express the state of emotion of the speaker.

According to Moore to define moral predicates in non-moral terms is fallacious and it does not answer the question of 'open question arguments'. The is/ought problem could be seen as an anticipation for naturalistic fallacy.

David Hume was concerned whether ought can be admitted at all. But he emphasised the importance of ought in his moral philosophy, his normativity is situated at the level of facts. While in Kant there there is separation in sphere of facts and sphere of duties. He introduces ought in the strong external sense. Only through the postulation of a separate sphere of normativity that the ought could be defended. Kant and Hume agree on the point that one cannot deduce normative facts from factual truths. Both philosophers have different way of apprehending normative truths.

It is on the concept of common interest that ought to depend and can be explained only in terms of it. When we say we ought to do it is to affirm a common rule. The ought here can here be said to constitute a wide set of categorical imperatives. Though ontological status of the ought is controversial.

If a person says that an act is termed right if it is acceptable maximum number of people

All acts that contribute to happiness are right, If we take the example all round objects are red and all red objects objects are round, this does not imply that redness and roundness are the same.

'All acts that contribute to happiness are right' is an example of the above type though it is true that acts which contribute to happiness is right but it is not true to say that everything that makes us happy may not be always right. Here happiness is the criterion for an act to be right, still it does not mention what rightness consists of. Similarly, this can be applied to the words like 'good', 'ought ','duty' and the like.

So the the question that remains unanswered is "what does the word mean"?

Also what do we mean when we use such words. In such a situation can we conclude that such evaluative words have no clear meaning at all.

It is not that the word is meaningless, but the meaning of the word differ from person to person. When we say a person is good or a chair is good or the painting is good there are different meanings for the word good. So give a meaning in one context and another meaning in another context. Still the question remains why the same word is used in different contexts. When we say 'X is good' or 'X is round', here X possesses the quality of goodness and roundness. Both defines an objective property; one is an ethical property while the other is geometrical. If both roundness and goodness are considered as objective entities then what sort entities are these.

In order to answer these questions utilitarian philosophers, the terms to intrinsic good and extrinsic good. Intrinsic means it is good even if the word stands alone, while in extrinsic sense it means it is an instrument to achieve something other than itself. Surgeon inflicting pain on a patient is an instrumentally good act. While if prisoners life is made very happy in jail, it would send a bad example to society. Here it is intrinsically a good act but instrumentally bad.

Hence rightness of an act is determined by goodness of the consequences of an act this is termed the extrinsic good. Rightness hence is the derivative of goodness. Utilitarian philosophers have held that state of happiness is a state of intrinsic goodness.

In the second interpretation by the utilitarian philosophers, they held that all state of happiness are not states of intrinsic goodness. When a Nazi uses the word right and Utilitarian uses it both have two sets of consequences; 'one having consequences A' and 'another having consequences B'.

1.7 NATURALISTIC FALLACY

It is the attitude to a particular act rather than whether the act is right or wrong. This is the reason why subjective theories are called attitude theories. In attitude theory there is assertion for one thing or another which is not the case with emotive theories. For emotive theories a search for cognitive meaning will be in vain, hence when an individual A advises another individual B to refrain from doing a particular act, A gets convinced only when B obeys it. There is no cognitive meaning being associated with it.

But in the modified emotive theory ethical terms have been given a certain amount of cognitive status as well in daily discourse. The meaning of the ethical term is emotive; the word does not stand for a property or characteristic of things. Even though the emotive meaning cannot be duplicated, still should derive its cognitive meaning

No non ethical words can duplicate the persuasive, imperative force of the ethical words.

When we call a pianist good, in spite of having a emotive meaning there should possibly be a cognitive side to it. There is always a persuasive-expressive element involved when the word is used. Suppose C is the characteristic in the pianist that is found fulfilling the expectation, this is taken as the cognitive meaning of "good" as used in the phrase" good pianist". It may be right for one person to divorce his wife while for second person it may not be right since he may have children or any other consequences. In the case of the first person it may bring more happiness while for the second it may bring more misery.

When cognitive meaning is present that too in varying degrees, it means there will be at least one property it is asserted to have, and then, of course, there would be genuine disagreements on whether or not X has this property. This is a difference of opinion on some matter of fact.

Seeing beauty with perfect accuracy is beyond human powers, but with increase in aesthetic awareness there is convergence of opinion. Those people who enjoyed Riley James

Whitecomb now enjoy Shakespeare and they now accept the fact that their former judgement was not aesthetic one.

In order to evaluate the value of a food item or a days work, it is the satisfaction it brings upon a human need or a relative estimate placed by a group of people that is taken in to consideration. The value of a food item can be seen by the way it provides relief for hunger and supporting life also having a pleasant experience of eating. It is dependent on the fact that we value life. These kind of value ascribed is called instrumental. The value of the food item is only instrumental and not intrinsic**. According to Kant nothing is good without qualification except goodwill. Kant regards goodwill to have intrinsic value. It is also an element in everything that is found intrinsically valuable.**

In Sidgwick's account pleasure is intrinsically valuable, it is the only thing that is intrinsically valuable. What we mean by intrinsically valuable is that we value them for themselves, rather than a means to anything. We consider things as valuable when getting it seems pleasant for us. In the case of knowledge, though it is pleasant to get knowledge, here what is valued is knowledge itself.

Cat playing with the mouse may not be enable us to say that it is intrinscally valuable.It is our direct object of rational choice which makes definition of intrinsic value possible.

G.E Moore in his text *principia ethica* states that the term good in the sense in which it is ethically important is incapable of definition. It is pleasant to get knowledge but it is the knowledge that we value, here pleasantness is the subjective aspect. Similarly, the pleasantness of getting pleasure is considered different from what it is primarily valued.

Since good cannot be defined by analysis in to its parts, since it does not appear to have any parts. It is accepted as simple sense datum, as a particular colour or smell, which has to be accepted as final. We can define the colour yellow by stating that yellow lies between green and orange. Also the number 5 can be defined as the number that lies between the cardinal number 4 and 6. Plato can be defined as the student of Socrates. When we try to define good in this way, we can connect good with the conception of value. One thing is treated more valuable than another hence values may be treated as positive and negative. We regard things as good which have positive value while things which have negative value is termed evil.

1.8 ETHICS AS NORMATIVE SCIENCE

In order to understand what normative science deals with there is a need to compare it with the aspects of positive science. Positive science deals with what is the case, it deals with facts and explains them by their causes. Here there is no question of judging its objects in any way.

Ethics deals with value. Hence ethics is concerned with judgement of value hence ethics is not a descriptive science. Normative ethics deals with standards or norms by which we can judge human actions to be right or wrong. Disciplines such as logic and aesthetics are concerned with truth and beauty they are also normative sciences. The three ideals of logic, aesthetics and ethics are truth, beauty and value.

Aesthetics, for example, deals systematically with the standards by which we judge objects of perception, commonly sights and sounds, to be beautiful or ugly. Logic deals with the standards by which we judge statements to be true or false, and ethics deals with the standards by which we judge human actions to be right or wrong. The normative sciences differ from positive sciences in one more way; they do not merely describe the standards by which we judge; they are also concerned with the validity or truth of these standards. In ethics for example it is not enough to describe the rules by which men have tested their conduct, such as the Ten Commandments of the Hebrews; we also ask in ethics why these rules are valid or on what grounds we ought to observe them.

Let us take an example regarding how we evaluate norms,

If someone says that 90 percent of all adults of certain part of world are overweight, this norm, is not derived from the result of a statistical survey, i.e.,it is not a comparison of weight of each individual with the average weight of the group of the population. Instead, they have a ideal weight for the people relative to their height are other factors, and this is used as a norm or standard in the sense of ideal model. It means it is not the statistically normalcy that we refer to instead the weight of the majority of individuals is more than they ought to be.

Why ethics is not a practical science ?

It is not a practical science since it is concerned with understanding the nature of the ideal and not formulate rules for its attainment. Also, most writers of ethics have preferred to treat it as purely speculative. Aesthetics as a discipline is concerned with norms to evaluate beauty but it does not try to understand how beauty is produced. Ethics deals with the norms as to how to evaluate goodness or rightness, it is not concerned with how it may may be attained.

Why ethics is not considered an art ?

Logic is considered as art of thinking, while ethics is in no way described as art of conduct. It is doubted that whether logic can be stated as art of thinking and ethics as art of conduct. It is best treat both logic and ethics as having no direct bearing upon these arts. Ethics does not teach us how to lead a moral life; it helps us justify goodness or rightness which leads us to the supreme goal of human life. So, like a practical science or like art it leads us to a goal. It is neither practical science nor art. Art especially deals with acquisition of skill to produce objects, while morality deals with motive, intention, purpose and choice which are considered right or wrong in the light of goodness. Therefore, morality consists of goodness, which is really an intrinsic end.

1.9 DISTINCTION BETWEEN POSITIVE AND NORMATIVE SCIENCE

Ethics is a normative science. It is concerned with what ought to be done rather than what is the case. It differs from positive science. A positive science, natural science or descriptive science is concerned with what is. It deals with facts and explains them by their causes. In positive science there is no question of judging its objects in any way. But ethics does not deal with fact. Rather it deals with value. Therefore, it is clear that ethics is concerned with judgments of value, while positive science deals with judgments of facts. That is why ethics is not a positive science but a normative science. Normative ethics deals with standards or norms by which we can judge human actions to be right or wrong. For example, logic, aesthetics are also considered as normative sciences, because logic and aesthetics are concerned with truth and beauty. So, truth, beauty and value are the three ideals of logic, aesthetics and ethics respectively. Aesthetics, for example, deals systematically with the standards by which we judge objects of perception, commonly sights and sounds, to be beautiful or ugly. Logic deals with the standards by which we judge statements to be true or false, and ethics deals with the standards by which we judge human actions to be right or wrong. The normative sciences differ from positive sciences in one more way; they do not merely describe the standards by which we judge; they are also concerned with the validity or truth of these standards.

The rules of ethics, logic and aesthetics is what ought to be and not what is. The laws of logic show the norms to which thinking must conform. Similarly, laws of ethics show the norms to which actions must conform. Normative sciences are evaluative rather than factual. As we know science deals only with facts and generalisation . The sciences like physics, chemistry, physiology, and psychology deal with the real. While certain norms and standards are set up by so called sciences such as logic, aesthetics and ethics upon which one has to evaluate.

Model questions

Anwer the following

1.Define Ethics
2.Define good
3. Define right
4. Describe the salient features of normative science.

Answer the following

5. What is Is/ought distinction?
6. Differentiate between Descriptive and normative science
7. Explain ethics is a normative science
8. Evaluate IS/OUGHT distinction.
9. What is naturalistic fallacy?

Essay question

10. Explain the nature and scope of ethics